

too. She's earning about three times what she made in the academic world.

Changing jobs and careers is a major step, and you should move with caution. But if you act with a clear head, and are honest about your motives, you're bound to be a success. You'll get a kick out of your work, learn new skills, and make more money.

And you'll be on the road to very early retirement.

CONTROL YOUR SPENDING

Pushing your job to its limit, changing jobs, or changing careers may put you on a faster track. But Nancy is already on a fast track. She makes good money. Yet Nancy can't save a dime.

The problem is that Nancy spends recklessly. Money flies out of Nancy's purse the way newspapers fly out of a high-speed press. Nancy's attitude is: why walk two blocks when you can take a cab? Why drink \$30-a-bottle champagne when you can afford to drink bubbly for \$100? Why pay \$200 for a dress at Macy's when you can pay \$300 for the same thing at Neiman-Marcus? Why be a member of a health club you never use when you can be a member of two health clubs you never use?

To control spending you need to adopt a spending plan that fits your personality. You like to do things first-class? Then a spending plan that compels you to buy cheap theater seats, eat in greasy dives, and drink in local taverns is bound to fail. Instead, plan to go out first-class but to do it a little less often. If you're too impatient to check prices at the supermarket, try to get a spouse or child to take over that task. If certain stores tempt you to buy, avoid the stores. Better yet, shop by mail.

Still, when you save on household expenses you save nickels and dimes. Nickels and dimes can add up, and you *should* try to control household expenses. But to save big